

100 TIKTOK & REELS



VIRAL HOOKS

UNLOCK ENGAGEMENT, GO VIRAL & MASTER SHORT-FORM VIDEO

SIDEHUSTLE STUDIO

100 Viral Hooks & Scripts

For TikTok, Reels & Shorts — the scroll-stopping swipe file

100 Viral Hooks & Scripts for TikTok, Reels & Shorts

The scroll-stopping first 3 seconds are 90% of the battle. This is the complete swipe file of hooks that stop the thumb — plus how to use them.

Fill in the [BRACKETS] for your niche. Say the hook in the first 2 seconds, on camera or as bold on-screen text. Then deliver on the promise fast.

The 4 rules of a hook that actually works

1. **Front-load the payoff.** The viewer decides to stay or swipe in ~1.5 seconds. Lead with the most interesting word, not a greeting.
2. **Create an open loop.** Tease the answer, don't give it. The brain hates an unfinished pattern and stays to close it.
3. **Be specific.** "3 tips" beats "some tips." "£4,300 in 9 days" beats "a lot of money."
4. **Match hook to payoff.** Never clickbait beyond what you deliver — the algorithm punishes fast drop-off harder than it rewards a big open.

On-screen text tip: the hook should be readable in one glance, 5–8 words max, high contrast, top-third of the frame (away from captions/UI).

SECTION 1 — Curiosity Gap Hooks (1–15)

1. "Nobody talks about this [NICHE] trick, and it's kind of illegal how well it works."
2. "The thing that [DESIRED RESULT] isn't what you think — it's this."
3. "I wasn't going to share this, but here's how I [RESULT]."
4. "There's a reason [SUCCESSFUL GROUP] never explains how they actually do it."
5. "You've been doing [COMMON TASK] wrong your whole life. Here's the fix."
6. "This one setting/tool/habit changed everything about my [AREA]."
7. "Watch this before you [COMMON ACTION] — it'll save you [PAIN]."
8. "The [INDUSTRY] doesn't want you to know how simple this is."
9. "I found the loophole in [SYSTEM], and here it is."
0. "Everyone's ignoring the easiest way to [RESULT]. Let me show you."
1. "This took me 6 months to figure out. It'll take you 30 seconds."
2. "The reason you're stuck at [PLATEAU] is smaller than you think."
3. "Save this before it gets taken down."
4. "There's a hidden [FEATURE/step] that does 80% of the work."
5. "If you know this one thing, [HARD TASK] becomes stupidly easy."

SECTION 2 — Bold Claim & Contrarian Hooks (16–30)

6. "Stop [COMMON ADVICE]. It's quietly killing your [RESULT]."
7. "Unpopular opinion: [COMMON BELIEF] is completely backwards."

8. "You don't need [EXPENSIVE THING] to [RESULT]. You need this."
9. "[POPULAR THING] is dead. Here's what actually works in 2026."
0. "I quit [COMMON PRACTICE] and my [METRIC] doubled."
1. "Everything you've been told about [TOPIC] is a myth."
2. "The best [NICHE] advice is the exact opposite of what's trending."
3. "Delete [POPULAR APP/TOOL]. Do this instead."
4. "Rich people [DO X]. Broke people [DO Y]. Here's the difference."
5. "If you're still doing [OLD METHOD] in 2026, you're losing money daily."
6. "The '[POPULAR TIP]' hack is a trap. Here's why."
7. "Nobody needs another [GENERIC THING]. You need this instead."
8. "I was wrong about [TOPIC] for years. This is what changed my mind."
9. "Hot take: [COMMON GOAL] is easy. Everyone just overcomplicates it."
0. "Your [PROBLEM] isn't a [OBVIOUS CAUSE] problem. It's a [REAL CAUSE] problem."

SECTION 3 — Number & List Hooks (31–45)

1. "3 [TOOLS/tips] that feel illegal to know for free."
2. "5 signs you're about to [BAD OUTCOME] — and how to stop it."
3. "I tested 20 [THINGS] so you don't have to. Here are the 3 that work."
4. "7 words that instantly [DESIRED EFFECT]."
5. "The 2-minute routine that [RESULT]."
6. "4 mistakes keeping you broke in [NICHE]."
7. "10 seconds to fix the #1 thing wrong with your [THING]."
8. "3 free tools that replace a £[X]/month subscription."
9. "The only 3 [THINGS] you actually need to [GOAL]."
0. "5 things I'd do first if I started [JOURNEY] from zero today."
1. "6 red flags in [SITUATION] everyone ignores."
2. "8 out of 10 people fail at [TASK] for the same reason."
3. "2 changes that took my [METRIC] from [LOW] to [HIGH]."
4. "The 1% who [SUCCEED] all do these 3 things."
5. "100 [PEOPLE] tried this. Here's what the winners had in common."

SECTION 4 — Story & Transformation Hooks (46–60)

6. "6 months ago I was [BEFORE]. Today I'm [AFTER]. Here's exactly what changed."
7. "I made £[AMOUNT] in [TIMEFRAME] doing this. Let me break it down."
8. "The day I stopped [BAD HABIT], everything shifted."
9. "This message changed my whole [AREA]." (*show screenshot*)
0. "I almost quit [PURSUIT]. Then this happened."
1. "From [EMBARRASSING START] to [IMPRESSIVE RESULT] — the honest version."
2. "Nobody believed this would work. Here's the receipt." (*show proof*)
3. "I tried [TREND] for 30 days. This is what actually happened."
4. "My biggest [NICHE] failure taught me the thing that finally worked."

5. "A stranger gave me one piece of advice that [RESULT]."
6. "Year 1 vs Year 2 of [JOURNEY] — the difference is one decision."
7. "I spent £[AMOUNT] learning this so you can have it in 40 seconds."
8. "The email that landed me [BIG WIN]. I'll read it to you."
9. "This is what [RESULT] actually looks like behind the scenes."
0. "I did the ugly, boring thing for 90 days. Here's what it got me."

SECTION 5 — Problem / Pain-Point Hooks (61–75)

1. "If your [THING] isn't [RESULT], it's almost always because of this."
2. "Tired of [PAIN]? This is the actual fix, not another band-aid."
3. "The reason your [EFFORT] isn't working has nothing to do with effort."
4. "You're not [NEGATIVE LABEL]. You're just missing this one step."
5. "That sinking feeling when [RELATABLE PAIN]? Here's how to end it."
6. "Struggling with [PROBLEM]? Watch this before you give up."
7. "Your [THING] is invisible online, and here's exactly why."
8. "This is the mistake costing you [SPECIFIC LOSS] every single week."
9. "Why does [COMMON TASK] feel so hard? It shouldn't. Here's the reason."
0. "You keep [BAD OUTCOME] because nobody told you this."
1. "The silent [NICHE] killer nobody warns you about."
2. "If [SITUATION] sounds familiar, this video is for you."
3. "You've tried everything for [PROBLEM] — except this."
4. "The gap between you and [GOAL] is one habit, not one year."
5. "Stop blaming [WRONG CAUSE]. The real reason is this."

SECTION 6 — How-To & Value Hooks (76–90)

6. "How to [RESULT] in [SHORT TIMEFRAME] — step by step."
7. "Here's the exact system I use to [RESULT], free."
8. "Do this every morning for [TIMEFRAME] and watch [METRIC] climb."
9. "Copy this [TEMPLATE/routine] word for word."
0. "The fastest way to [RESULT] with zero [BUDGET/experience]."
1. "Steal my exact [PROCESS] for [OUTCOME]."
2. "Turn [INPUT] into [OUTPUT] in 3 steps. Watch."
3. "The beginner-proof way to [SKILL], starting today."
4. "Give me 60 seconds and I'll fix your [THING]."
5. "Here's how to [RESULT] without [COMMON REQUIREMENT]."
6. "The plug-and-play [SYSTEM] for [GOAL] — pause and screenshot."
7. "How I automate [TASK] so it runs while I sleep."
8. "The 3-step framework behind every [SUCCESSFUL THING]."
9. "Want [RESULT]? Do exactly this, in this order."
0. "This is the shortcut. There's no catch — here it is."

SECTION 7 — Engagement & Call-Out Hooks (91–100)

1. "If you [DO/HAVE X], this video was made for you."
 2. "Comment '[WORD]' and I'll send you [FREE THING]."
 3. "Tag someone who needs to hear this about [TOPIC]."
 4. "Only [GROUP] will understand this. Are you one of them?"
 5. "Be honest — how many of these [MISTAKES] are you making?"
 6. "Watch till the end, the last one is the one nobody expects."
 7. "Rate your [THING] out of 10 in the comments after this."
 8. "This is your sign to finally start [ACTION]."
 9. "Send this to your past self who [SITUATION]."
 0. "If you made it this far, you're already ahead of 90% of people. Here's your next step."
-

The Universal Viral Script Structure (use with any hook above)

Every high-performing short follows the same skeleton. Drop a hook in slot 1 and you have a video:

[0–2s] HOOK — one line from this pack. Bold on-screen text + say it out loud. **[2–5s] STAKES** — why they should care right now ("this is costing you...", "most people never..."). **[5–25s] PAYOFF** — deliver the promise in tight, numbered beats. Cut every dead second. **[25–35s] PROOF** — a number, a screenshot, a before/after — one credibility hit. **[35–40s] CTA** — one action: follow for part 2, comment a keyword, save this. Never stack CTAs.

Retention boosters (the algorithm rewards these)

- **Re-hook at ~40%** of the video ("but here's the part that actually matters...") to save the drop-off.
- **Text on screen the whole time** — most people watch on mute.
- **Loop the ending to the beginning** so the replay counts as extra watch time.
- **Cut the first frame ruthlessly** — no intros, no "hey guys," no logo animations. Value in second one.

Posting rhythm that compounds

- 1 post/day beats 7 posts once a week — consistency trains the algorithm.
 - Reuse a winning hook across 5 different payoffs; ride what works.
 - Repost your top performers to Reels and Shorts — same file, 3x the reach.
-

© [YOUR NAME]. Licensed for personal and commercial use by the purchaser. Use these hooks freely in your own content. Do not resell or redistribute this document as-is.